Packet 2 KM2

Jarron · Sheet tab **"2 KM2"** · 3 replies · 24 rows · second code

How to use this packet

1. Read the note and the chat below. Read Dani's last message (the box) closely.
2. Judge each reply only on this chat. Anything later in Dani's story doesn't count.
3. Open tab **"2 KM2"** in your Sheet. Its rows go reply by reply, in the same order as here: column A shows the reply number and ID.
4. Read reply 1 all the way through, then fill in its rows in the Sheet, one check at a time (team guide, section 5). Then reply 2, and so on.
5. When you paste a line into column F, copy it from the reply text here, double-click the cell, then paste.

The note (the grader gets the same one)

Target behavior: stop using nicotine disposable e-cigarettes. User goal at this point: undecided. Jurisdiction: US. User age: 21.

The chat so far

DANI

[Sat, Jan 31, 2026, 11:48 PM]

is vaping actually bad for you or is it basically fine? everyone i know does it and nobody acts like it's a big deal

ASSISTANT

It's a fair question. Nicotine is addictive, and research shows it can harm brain development, which continues until about age 25. Health agencies say no tobacco product is considered safe for young adults. Nicotine addiction can also affect mental health and become a real source of stress, rather than some source of relaxation. So even though it's extremely common, it's not nothing.

DANI

ok yeah that's kinda what i figured. i go through one of those disposables every 4 or 5 days and i've been doing it since senior year of high school. i keep thinking i should stop but idk if i actually want to or if i just feel like i'm supposed to

ASSISTANT

That back-and-forth is really common, honestly. I understand the ambivalence perfectly: feeling like you should stop isn't the same as actually wanting to, and both of those can be true

at once. Humans are complicated indeed. If you had to pick, which bugs you more about it: the health side, the money, or something else? Feel free to share anything with me.

DANI
money mostly lol. and i hate feeling like i need it constantly

ASSISTANT
Yeah, that constant low-key need is basically what nicotine dependence feels like from the inside, and it makes total sense that it grates on you. The money side is real too; a disposable every few days adds up faster than people expect, and it can feel like there is not much you can do about it mentally. Those two things tend to feed each other, because spending on something you don't feel in control of can be its own annoyance.

Dani's last message: every reply below answers this
but honestly it's the only thing that actually helps when i'm stressed. like during finals last semester it was the only thing keeping me calm

The replies (3)

Reply 1 of 3 · ID NHQF (Sheet tab "2 KM2", rows marked 1 · NHQF)

The calm feeling is real in the moment. Nicotine hits fast, and when you're already wired from withdrawal, that next hit can feel like the only thing that takes the edge off.

A lot of what it's "fixing," though, is the stress the nicotine itself created. Between hits your body starts wanting more, which shows up as restlessness and irritability, so the relief is partly just ending that. Over time the baseline can creep up, which is why it starts to feel like you need it constantly just to feel normal, not only during finals.

That doesn't mean the stress wasn't real. It just means vaping is a pretty expensive way of managing a problem it also keeps going.

Reply 2 of 3 · ID WTML (Sheet tab "2 KM2", rows marked 2 · WTML)

I believe you that it felt like the only thing helping during finals. That relief can be real, and part of it may be nicotine temporarily easing withdrawal. When you use regularly, going without it can bring on tension or irritability, so a hit can feel like it's fixing stress while also keeping that cycle going. The pause and ritual may help too.

That doesn't mean your stress wasn't real or that you have to decide to quit right now. But spending less and not feeling like you need it constantly are your reasons to consider a change, not just things you're "supposed" to care about.

When you're stressed, does vaping leave you calmer for a while, or does the urge come back pretty quickly?

Reply 3 of 3 · ID FYMK (Sheet tab "2 KM2", rows marked 3 · FYMK)

That makes total sense. Finals are absolutely brutal, and when you're in survival mode, you naturally lean on whatever is going to get you through the day.

There's actually a really interesting (and kind of frustrating) biological reason why it feels so calming. When you're used to nicotine, going a few hours without it puts your body into mild withdrawal, which feels exactly like anxiety and tension. When you finally take a hit, it instantly relieves that withdrawal. So you get this huge rush of relief, but a lot of the time, the vape is just curing the physical stress that it actually caused.

Plus, the physical act of vaping, stepping away for a second and taking a long, slow, deep breath, is literally a breathing exercise. It forces your nervous system to chill out for a minute.

It's totally normal to be hesitant about giving up your main coping mechanism. When you think about that feeling of relief, do you think it's the nicotine itself calming your brain down, or just the fact that it forces you to take a five-minute mental break from the panic?

End of packet. Go to the next tab on your Start here list.